making under an informal approach is "responsive to the requirements of the situation" (Christiansen et al 2003, p.10).

Informal binding efforts make a piecemeal approach more efficient. They incrementally increase the chance of reaching an agreement between key stakeholders in a situation where reaching formal arrangements is cumbersome. After a decades-long conflict, Myanmar's peace process is complex and opaque. Some issues are almost impossible to deal with in a formal setting. In such cases, the peace technical team employs informal binding in order to remove immediate obstacles while aiming to solve underlying causes in the future. The second case study, on facilitation of ethnic summits, examines the piecemeal approach when combined with informal binding.

Facilitation of ethnic summits as informal binding: Under the previous military government, the 1908 Unlawful Associations Act, commonly known as 17(1) (in reference to its section assigning penalties for offences under the law), was used to detain those people associated with EAGs. Under this law, individuals contacting an unlawful organization can be imprisoned for a period of between two and three years. Ethnic leaders, lawmakers, and party leaders did not forget the 17(1) issue throughout the process. The peace technical team was often questioned about the possibility of the government's annulment of the law (Hlaing Kyaw Soe 2014). Although the government has been engaging the EAGs under the peace negotiation process, as of 2015 this act remains in force.

In this respect, the peace technical team's actions associated with the EAGs over the peace process have clearly been informal. The team has kept the underlying issue, the legalization of the EAGs, to be settled in the future. Therefore its approach to the 17(1) issue has become piecemeal in nature.

Despite 17(1), the peace technical team has bound the EAGs to the peace process by offering help for their on-the-ground needs associated with legal and formal constraints. The peace technical team not only helped form the ethnic alliance group, the NCCT, on 2 November 2013, but also facilitated ethnic summits for NCCT leaders in their regions. The EAGs' conferences were held in the Kachin Independence Organisation (KIO)'s capital Laiza, the Karen National Union (KNU)-controlled Lawkhila, and the Wa headquarters at Pang Sang from 2013 to 2015 respectively. These